MARKSMANSHIP PARENTAL PERMISSION FORM

Dear Parent/Guardian,

The Marine Corps Junior ROTC program achieves its objective of promoting citizenship and leadership in the youth of America through many different tools in its curriculum. Once such vital resource is cadet participation in marksmanship training.

Marksmanship is an activity deeply rooted in history. Today it lives on in thousands of clubs, organizations, and as a winter and summer Olympic event. In fact, some of the greatest rifle shooters in Olympic history are Americans, including the only two Olympians to ever win two individual Olympic medals in the event. One of these elite shooters is Gary Anderson who won gold medals for the United States in 1964 and 1968. Gary Anderson now serves as the Director of the Civilian Marksmanship Program (CMP).

The CMP promotes firearms safety training and rifle practice for all qualified U.S. citizens with a special emphasis on youth. The CMP operates through a network of affiliated shooting clubs and associations that covers every state in the U.S. The clubs and associations offer firearms safety training and marksmanship courses as well as the opportunity for continued practice and competition.

The CMP was created by the U.S. Congress. The original purpose was to provide civilians an opportunity to learn and practice marksmanship skills so they would be skilled marksmen if later called on to serve the U.S. military. Over the years the emphasis of the program shifted to focus on youth development through marksmanship. From 1916 until 1996 the CMP was administered by the U.S. Army. The National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 1996 (TITLE XVI) created the Corporation for the Promotion of Rifle Practice & Firearms Safety, Inc. (CPRPFS) to take over administration and promotion of the CMP. The CPRPFS is a tax exempt not-for-profit 501©(3) organization that derives its mission from public law.

With the training and support of the CMP, MCJROTC instructors guide cadets in the safe participation in the marksmanship sport of Three Position Air Rifle Shooting. Three-Position Air Rifle Shooting is the most popular and fastest growing form of shooting sports competition for youth of high school age or younger. Two different Three-Position Air Rifle events are available. Precision Air Rifle is modeled after Olympic-style shooting and allows the use of specialized target rifles and equipment. Sporter Air Rifle is designed for new competitors or those who desire to compete with a minimum amount of equipment and expense. In both types of shooting, competitors fire at targets at a distance of 10 meters in three different positions, prone, standing and kneeling.

With the use of the Daisy 853CM, a MCJROTC modified version of the original Daisy 853C air rifle, cadets participate in local, sate and national competitions. Some of our past shooters have received scholarships and have gone on to shoot on the collegiate level. In addition to participating in a safe and exciting sport, students gain a wealth of intangible skills by participating in the sport of marksmanship.

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